

Improving access to imported food safety requirements

Imported food safety requirements are now included in the [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#).

See more about the [Inclusion of food safety requirements in BICON](#).

All biosecurity requirements must be met before [Imported Food Inspection Scheme](#) requirements apply.

Check our [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#) for biosecurity import conditions.

We classify imported food that presents a potential medium or high risk to public health as [risk food](#). All risk food is listed in the [Imported Food Control Order 2019](#).

Fish and fish products of a particular kind are classified as risk food

Fish of the families listed are considered histamine susceptible fish. This includes all fish in the families:

- Carangidae (for example, trevallies, jacks and pompanos)
- Clupeidae (for example, herrings, sardines)
- Coryphaenidae (for example, mahi-mahi)
- Engraulidae (for example, anchovy)
- Pomatomidae (for example, bluefish)
- Scomberesocidae (for example, king gars and saury)
- Scombridae (for example, tuna, mackerel and bonito).

Fish products that contain more than 300 g per kg of all or any of the fish in the families listed are also risk foods.

Fish and fish products classified as risk food may be whole, fillets or in portions. This includes fish and fish products that are:

- raw (fresh, chilled or frozen)
- processed (cooked, smoked, dried and pickled)
- [retorted](#) and [shelf stable](#).

Exclusions

Food from [New Zealand](#).

Declaring certificates

When lodging a [Full Import Declaration \(FID\)](#), use the correct ICS document code and certificate number for the food.

Community Protection (CP) question

You will need to answer this CP question when lodging your [full import declaration](#):

IFIS: Are the goods or do the goods contain more than 300 g/kg (30%) of fish of the family Scombridae, Coryphaenidae, Pomatomidae, Carangidae, Clupeidae, Engraulidae or Scomberesociidae? For more information search 'histamine susceptible fish' at www.agriculture.gov.au.

Inspection and testing

We refer consignments of fish and fish products of the families listed for analytical testing. During inspection, we will also conduct a visual and label assessment. Additional testing may also apply for certain [ready-to-eat finfish](#).

Table 1 shows the test that will be applied and permitted results for each food type.

Table 1, Food type, test applied and permitted result

Food type	Test applied	Permitted result
Fish in the family: The Australian fish names standard AS SSA 5300 may be used as a reference.	Histamine	Maximum level 200 mg/kg

Food safety risks

Food Standard Australia New Zealand (FSANZ) has given us [advice about the risk of fish and fish products](#) of the families listed are associated with histamine formation. These products present a potential medium or high risk to public health for histamine poisoning.

Voluntary foreign government certification arrangements

We have a [voluntary certification arrangement](#) in place with Canada and Thailand for the fish and fish products listed. Consignments of these foods from Canada and Thailand with a recognised government certificate have a reduced rate of inspection and testing.

Certificate requirements

Type of information	To include
National competent authority:	Canadian Food Inspection Agency
Recognised certificate title:	Certificate of Origin and Hygiene
ICS document code:	CI

Certificate requirements

Type of information	To include
National competent authority:	Ministry of Agriculture and Cooperatives – Department of Fisheries
Recognised certificate title:	Health Certificate for fishery and aquaculture products originating in Thailand
Additional requirement:	The certificate must identify that the food has been sourced from an establishment approved by the Department of Fisheries, Thailand .
ICS document code:	DOFHCTH

Glossary

Retorted

Animal products are retorted if they are heated in a hermetically sealed container to a minimum core temperature of 100°C, obtaining an Fo value of at least 2.8.

Shelf stable

Goods are shelf-stable if the:

- goods have been commercially manufactured
- goods have been packaged by the manufacturer
- goods are in that package
- package has not been opened or broken
- goods are able to be stored in the package at room or ambient temperature, and
- goods do not require refrigeration or freezing before the package is opened.

Version history

Date	Reference number	Amendment details
13/02/2023	HIS 12/2016	Amend the webpage to update the link to the list of fish processing establishments approved by the Department of Fisheries, Thailand.
11/10/2019	HIS 12/2016	

		Update to the webpage to include a link to the Fisheries Research and Development Corporation's fish names database.
08/08/2017	HIS 12/2016	Update to the webpage to provide additional detail about the sampling of histamine susceptible fish and fish products.
21/12/2016	HIS 12/2016	Updates the webpage to reflect amendments to the Imported Food Control Order 2001 to classify more species of fish and fish products as risk foods.
01/05/2014	SCM 05/2014	Replaces Imported Food Notice 09/12 Tests applied to risk category foods

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/food/type/histamine-susceptible-fish>